it until the Delhi High Court pulled up the Delhi government for keeping no record of where the oxygen coming to them was being diverted.[58] In response to the Bench, the Delhi government's excuse presented by their Senior Advocate Rahul Mehra was, 'The government has found itself in an unprecedented situation and that it was "learning".'[59] The Court further observed that the controls imposed by the state government were leading to hoarding of cylinders and also noted that a substantial quantity of oxygen was supplied to gas re-fillers, but there was no mechanism or account for further supplies that they made to hospitals or nursing homes. Further, the Court also observed that Seth Air Supply, which was also one of the vendors for oxygen supply to the Delhi government, was not given a formal order to supply. The Court noted, 'We are surprised. Seth appears to be a rather big supplier. They are holding 20 MTs of liquid medical oxygen but they do not form part of your order. There seems to be something fishy. It cannot just be an oversight. Why are they not part of your order? You are crying you do not have oxygen but the vendor does not know whom to supply.'[60]

In addition, citing orders from the Delhi government to hospitals asking the latter to ensure that each patient that presents themselves at the hospital must be provided with oxygen and medical supplies within 15 minutes, the Bench reprimanded the Delhi government stating, 'You are completely out of sync and you do not know what the ground reality is. You do not know how hospitals are coping with the situation—what is the inflow of people, shortage of oxygen and medicine, doctors and paramedics. Why do you come up with these orders? We do not understand. You think you have discharged your duty by issuing this kind of order and the public will be happy that the government has issued this kind of order? Let us tell you this is nothing but a paper exercise. You are just satisfying your own conscience probably.'[61] Concluding the hearing, the Court asked the Chief Secretary of Delhi Vijay Kumar Dev to hold a meeting with oxygen suppliers, re-fillers, hospitals and nursing home immediately to work out a distribution plan.[62]

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Under such tense circumstances, the prime minister held a video conference with chief ministers of high-burden states on 23 April, urging them to aggressively adopt trace, track and treat mechanisms to put a halt to the